

Ants and termites

There are more termites and ants on Earth than any other type of insect – there are trillions of them! They live in groups called colonies.



Ant



Termites

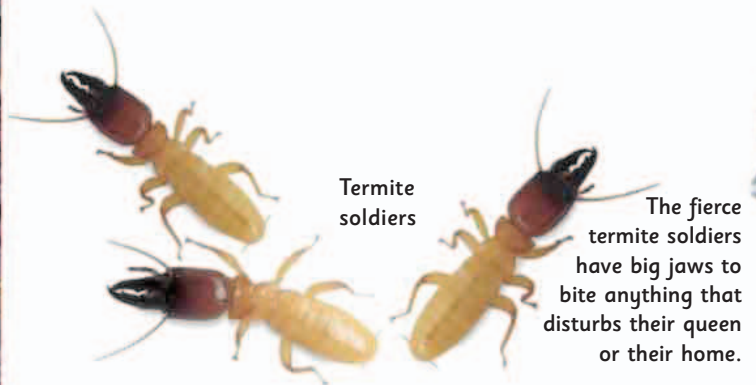
Termites live in hot, tropical areas. Each colony has a queen who is the chief and she has a king. Workers clean and feed, and soldiers guard.



In some species, the queen grows into a huge egg-laying machine, producing 30,000 eggs in a day!

Ants

There are many different types of ant, one or more living in almost every part of the world. These are leaf-cutter ants, which collect leaves and turn them into food.



Termite soldiers

The fierce termite soldiers have big jaws to bite anything that disturbs their queen or their home.

Termite mounds

Some termites live in huge mounds, which they build using earth, saliva, and their droppings – one piece on top of another, like bricks. Some mounds can be up to 7 m (25 ft) high.

Inside the mound

Each termite mound contains a huge network of rooms and passages. The queen and her eggs stay in the nursery, which is located in the centre.

The walls of termite mounds are so hard that you would need a pickaxe to get into them!